

THE MOTION

This Club Would

make eligibility for the legal and financial benefits of marriage conditional on having a child within five years of marriage

MARK WHERE YOU STAND, NOW AND ON THE WAY OUT AS IT IS ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ TIE TO CHILDREN

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

LEGAL AND FINANCIAL BENEFITS

What the state gives spouses and not unmarried partners: inheritance without a will, a family pension, tax free gifts, maintenance, spousal visas.

HAVING A CHILD

By birth or by adoption. An adopted child counts.

WITHIN FIVE YEARS

Counted from the wedding. A couple without a child by then stays married and lives as it likes. Only the benefits are at stake.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

India's birth rate is below replacement, and the state already treats married couples differently from everyone else. Nobody wants the state ending marriages.

THEY SPLIT ON

Where does a marriage get its value: the bond between two people, or raising the next generation?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

The state backs marriage because families raise the next generation. Benefits for couples who don't raise one are a subsidy with no return.

AGAINST

The benefits protect the partner, not the children. That promise is worth the same without a child, and a five year clock punishes infertility and marrying late.

YOUR CASE

Four or five points, one line each, in your own words. On stage you take them one at a time and elaborate, so write the trigger and not the speech.

1

BECAUSE

2

BECAUSE

3

BECAUSE

4

BECAUSE

HOW TO DO THIS

BEFORE YOU SPEAK

Write your four strongest points on the front, one line each. Not a speech, just what will remind you of one.

ON STAGE

Take them one at a time and elaborate. A couple of minutes, so roughly thirty seconds a point.

IN THE REBUTTAL

Write down the claim the other side actually made, then answer that one, not the one you wish they had made.

THE ORDER

ROUND ONE

1 Speech, for

2 Speech, against

3 Rebuttals

4 Open floor

ROUND TWO

5 Speech, for

6 Speech, against

7 Rebuttals

8 Open floor

The room votes before the first speech and again after the last. Anyone may take an open floor, drawn or not.

WHILE THEY SPEAK

One row, one exchange. Their claim on the left, your answer on the right.

THEY SAID

MY ANSWER

ROUND ONE

1

2

3

ROUND TWO

4

5

6

THE ONE SENTENCE

The last thing you say is the thing the room votes on. Write it before you stand up.